

PUNCTUATION MARK	NAME	USE
.	period (US) full stop (UK)	- marks the end of a complete statement - marks the end of an abbreviated word
...	ellipsis	marks where text has been omitted or a sentence is unfinished
,	comma	- follows an introductory word, phrase, or clause - can separate a non-essential part of a sentence - can be used with a conjunction to join two main clauses - separates words or phrases in a list - represents omitted words to avoid repetition in a sentence - can be used between an introduction to speech and direct speech
;	semi-colon	- separates two main clauses that are closely related - separates items in a complex list
:	colon	- connects a main clause to a clause, phrase, or word that is an explanation of the main clause, or that emphasizes a point in the main clause - introduces a list after a complete statement - introduces quoted text
'	apostrophe	- marks missing letters - indicates possession
-	hyphen	- links two words in compound modifiers and some compound nouns - can be used in fractions and in numbers from twenty-one to ninety-nine - can join certain prefixes to other words
" "	inverted commas	- can be used before and after direct speech and quoted text - pick out a word or phrase in a sentence - can be used around titles of short works
?	question mark	marks the end of a sentence that is a question
!	exclamation mark	- marks the end of a sentence that expresses strong emotions - can be used at the end of an interruption to add emphasis
()	parentheses (US) brackets (UK)	- can be used around non-essential information in a sentence - can be used around information that provides clarification
—	dash	- can be used in pairs around interruptions - marks a range of numbers (5–6 hours) - indicates start and end of a route (Paris–Dover rally)
•	bullet point	indicates a point in a list
/	slash	can be used to show an alternative instead of using the word “or”